



1613

## ROMANOV'S RULE RUSSIA

The extinction of the Rurik dynasty in 1598 plunged Russia into the Time of Troubles. After the brief and brutal rule of Boris Godunov ended in 1605, various pretenders competed for the throne. In 1613, the Zemsky Sobor (parliament) elected 16-year-old Mikhail Romanov as tsar. Benefiting from a widespread desire for order, Tsar Mikhail ruled until 1645, founding a dynasty that lasted over 300 years.

◁ Dish showing election of Mikhail Romanov

1610

**1611 King Gustavus Adolphus** inherits the throne of Sweden at the age of 16

**1610 The French king Henry IV** is killed by Catholic fanatic François Ravallac

**1612 Tobacco exports** begin from the Colony of Virginia in North America to England

**1615 Spaniard Miguel de Cervantes** completes his comic novel *Don Quixote*

1616

## NURHACI CHALLENGES THE MING

A chieftain of the Manchu people north of China's Great Wall, Nurhaci unified the northern tribes under his rule. Creating a state organized into military sections called "banners", he laid claim to northern China. His armies scored notable victories against the Ming Chinese before his death in 1626. His successors would eventually conquer the Ming Empire.



△ Nurhaci, Manchu chieftain

▽ Battle of Osaka, 17th-century screen



1615

## BATTLE OF OSAKA

The dominance of the Tokugawa clan, shoguns (military rulers) of Japan from 1603, was contested by the Toyotomi clan. Based at Osaka Castle, Toyotomi Hideyori gathered a large army to defy the Tokugawa. Starting in winter 1614, a long siege of the castle ended with a decisive battle in May 1615 in which the Toyotomi were defeated and the castle was captured.



**1547-1616  
MIGUEL DE CERVANTES**

Cervantes led an adventurous life, fighting the Turks at Lepanto in 1571 and later being captured by North African pirates. His books, including the novel *Don Quixote*, were written in his later years.